

PhotoModular FX

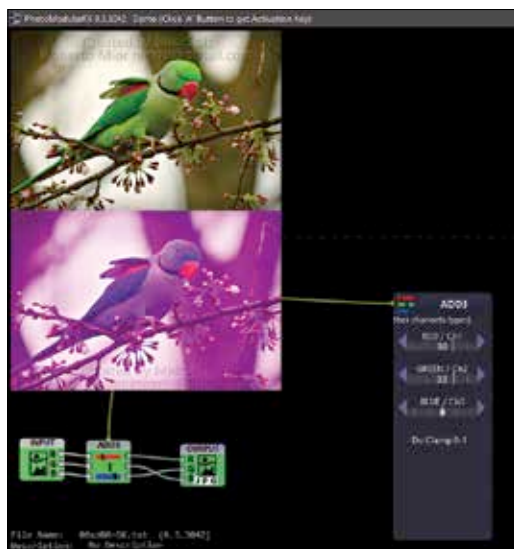


Create your own custom filters

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PhotoModular FX is a little different from other photo editing software out there. Photo editing software work by modifying the parameters of individual pixels, based on inputs from the user and calculations. For example, when a user wants to colour correct a photo in photoshop, they have to use the picker tool to select the whitest pixel in the picture, and the blackest pixel in the picture. These pixels can be identified by dragging the Threshold slider either to the extreme right or the extreme left. Then, the values of all the other pixels in the image, are changed relative to the brightest and darkest pixel, giving a perfect contrast. The lightest part of the image is white, and the darkest part of the image is black. There are situations where the approach would give horrible results, such as a grey computer chassis kept on a grey table in a grey room. For the most part though, all the magic of photo editing software is in the values of each pixel, in any colour space being used, say RGB, LAB, CMYK or HSL being modified based on the input. PhotoModular FX gives you granular control over these operations, by allowing you to pick and choose various kinds of modifica-

tions, which are pulled in as nodes to the workflow. The two vital nodes for the pipeline to work are the input and output nodes. The values are derived from the input nodes, modified through a number of processing nodes, and then exported into an output. The image processing nodes, or modules, can be strung up in series or parallel operations, with any number of nodes being added as necessary. While on a fundamental level, PhotoModular FX works very different from style transfer apps such as Prisma, the end results can be very similar. The neural network based style transfer apps do not exactly make filters, but think about tweaking the contrast, strength of effect, thickness of lines in the various



A simple project with a single module

styles offered by Prisma, using a simpler software to create filters, and you have PhotoModular FX. If nothing else, the software should get you familiar with nodal editing, which is used in a number of applications, including more advanced image editing software. PhotoModular FX is lightweight and portable, but is processor intensive, and applying the effects of a filter can be a time consuming process. Do note that PhotoModularFX output has a large and obvious watermark, which can be removed for free by emailing a product key to the programmer, who sends back an activation key.

A SIMPLE FIRST PROJECT

Using the preset filters and understanding how they are put together is a good way to start. Each of the filters are a flow of modules that are saved as projects. There will be a number of modules in the project, take some time to understand the relationships and connections between the modules, and how they are piped together to provide a particular result. Left clicking on any module gives you the particular options of that module that can be tweaked. Right click on a module to remove it from the project. Bear in mind that there always needs to be at least one module

apart from the input module, or the software is likely to crash. While the input module cannot be deleted, the output module can. Once you have loaded a project, left click in the top left corner to load an image from your system. We will now proceed to create a simple filter, with a single FX module, apart from the input and output modules. Click on Add FX-Module, and select the ADD3 module. This allows you to modify the RGB values of the image. From the input module, click and drag pathways to the three corresponding channels in